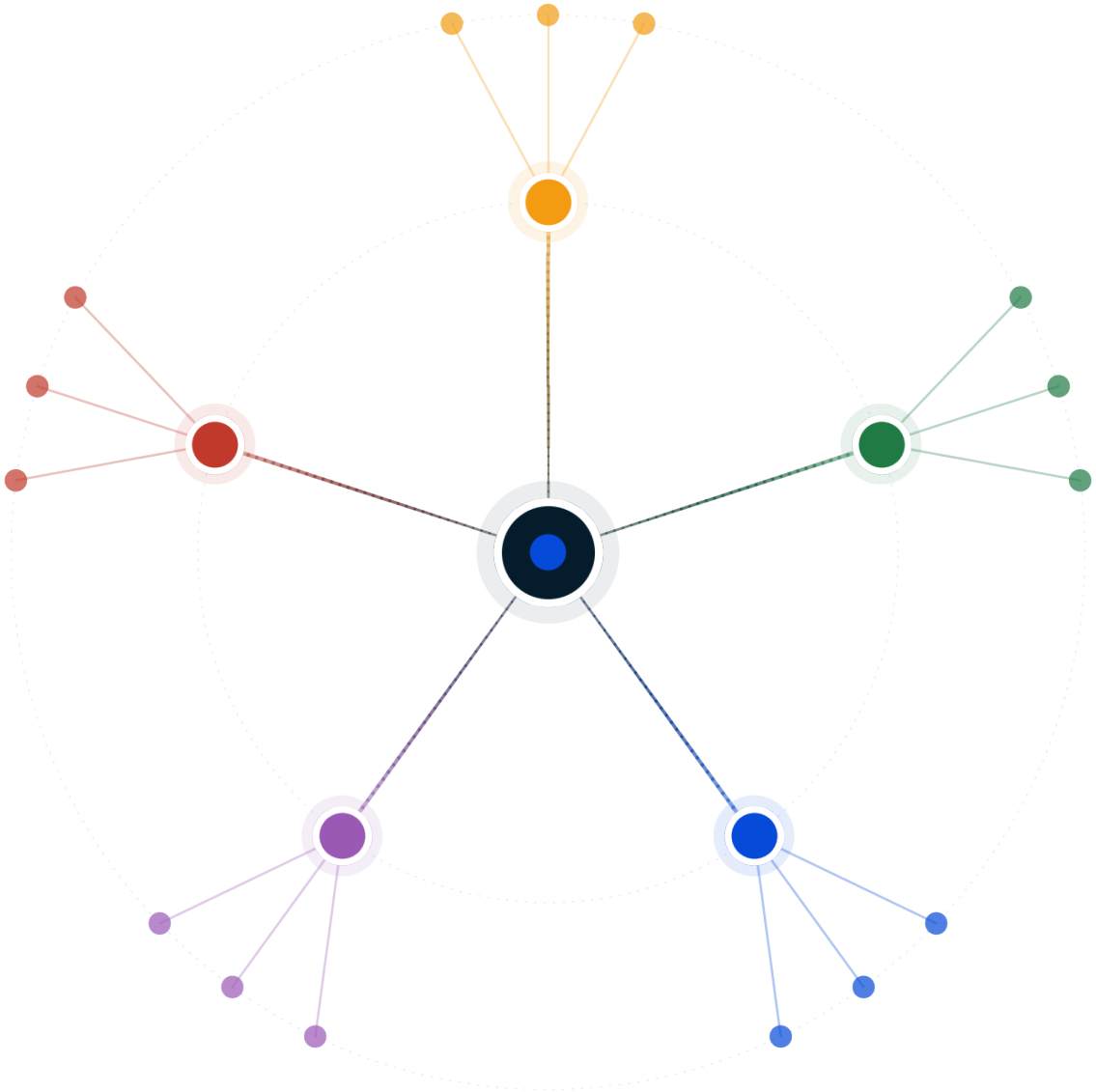
Autodecision

Buy in Bangalore, rent + invest, or relocate to SF?



Decision Brief — possibility map and recommendation

April 2026

GENERATED BY AUTODECISION — possibility map with synthesized recommendation, not a single-shot answer

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No option dominates; ship the staged real-options path with buy-small as the default endpoint

Phase 1 (Months 0-36): rent near grandparents + 100% delta into 70/30 SIP + cross-border tax advisor + H1B exploration. Gate 1 at Year 3: if visa secured + alignment + discipline → Phase 2 SF; else → Buy-Small (4-5 Cr apartment + invest remainder). Phase 3: return with USD savings if SF executes.

CONFIDENCE

MEDIUM · values-driven (not information-limited) · 38/60 score, did not reach 70% threshold · further iteration would refine probabilities by 5-10% only

DEPENDS ON

Investment discipline >70% of planned delta [G10] · Both H1Bs secured [G5] · Marriage alignment 7+/10 at every gate · Grandparent availability 3+ yrs · SF savings hold $80-120K [G4]

MONITOR

Quarterly: SIP rate (kill at <60% for 2 quarters) · Couple happiness (pause at <5/10) · H1B lottery results · Bangalore AQI · AI salary compression in SF roles

PRE-MORTEM

Decision fatigue → impulsive commitment (P=0.35) · Phase 1 becomes permanent (P=0.30, converges to buy-small — not failure) · Visa never materializes (P=0.45 by yr 5) · Marriage strain from optionality (P=0.25)

DEEPEST DISAGREEMENT

Discipline vs forced savings: rent+invest beats buying ONLY at 70% investment rate × 11% CAGR. India SIP base rate is 50%+ discontinuation within 3 yrs [G10]. Disagreement IS the data.

REVIEW TRIGGER

SIP rate <60% (2 quarters) · Both H1Bs fail same year · AQI >Very Poor 90+ days/yr · Second child confirmed · One spouse <5/10 happiness · 15%+ SF salary compression

Source: Decision Brief (full mode, 2 iterations, did not converge — values-driven) · [G4], [G5], [G10]

PART 2

How we explored this decision

A 5-persona council, 7 competing hypotheses, 2 iterations on a values-driven decision, 5 adversarial findings — what survived?

Seven hypotheses across 2 iterations of a 5-persona council, stress-tested by 5 adversarial findings

- 5 personas spawned as separate subagents — Growth Optimist, Risk Pessimist, Competitor Strategist, Constraint Analyst, Family Advocate — each with independent context
- 7 hypotheses generated, including h2 split into disciplined (2a) and realistic (2b) variants in iteration 2 to expose the behavioural assumption
- 2 iterations — convergence NOT reached (38/60 score vs 70% threshold) because the disagreement is values-driven, not information-limited; further iteration would refine by 5-10% only
- Adversary surfaced 3 worst-case scenarios + 2 critical structural findings (sequential probability collapse, correlated layoff/market risk)
- Sensitivity analysis on 8 assumptions — 4 high-sensitivity (3 of which are FRAGILE), 2 medium, 2 low
- Real-world anchors: Indian SIP discontinuation 50%+ within 3 years [G10], H1B household visa 55% by year 3 [G5], INR/USD depreciation 3-4%/yr structural [G7]

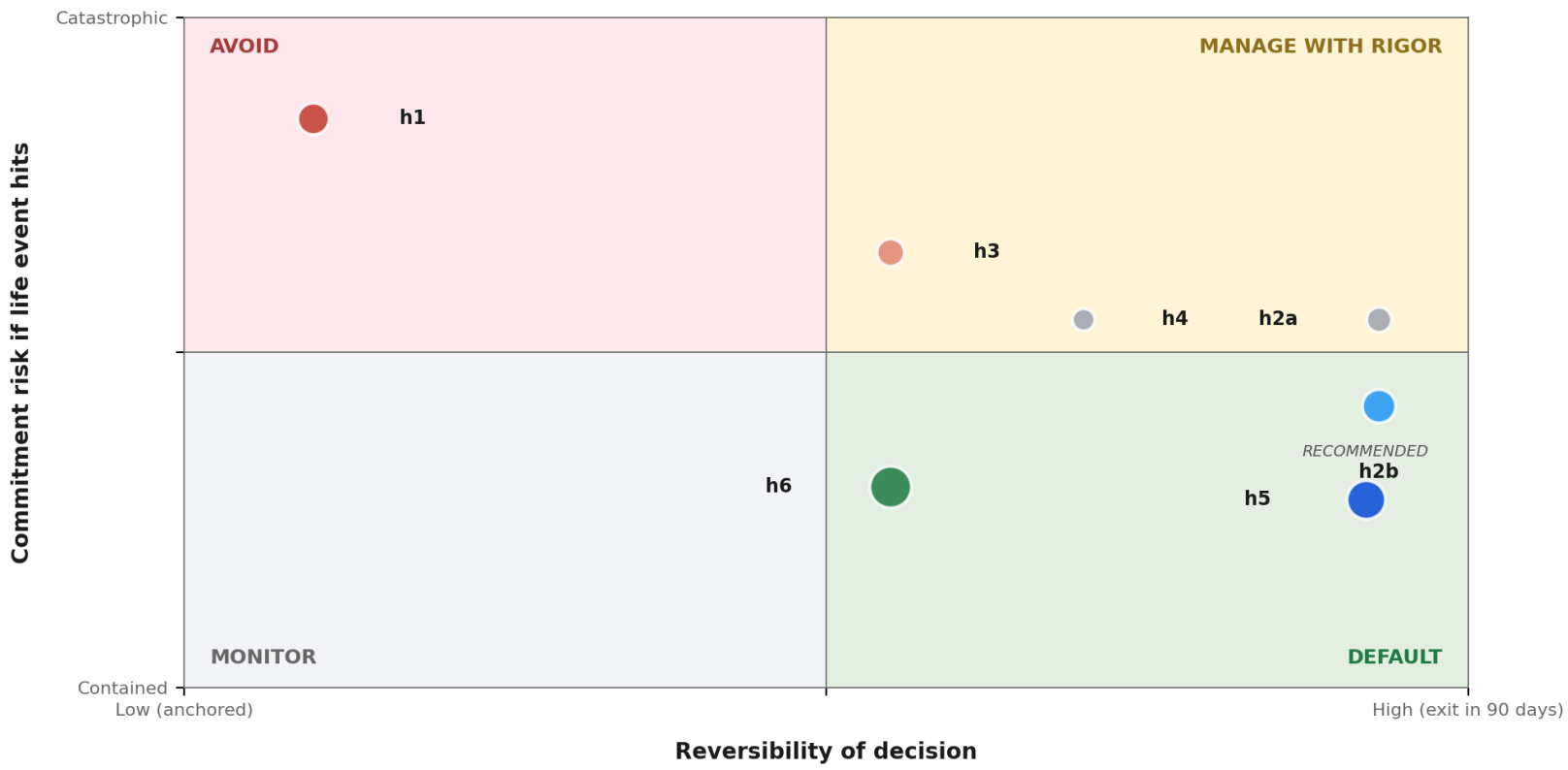
Source: Decision Brief Convergence Log; engine-protocol.md

Seven hypotheses surfaced; the staged path (h5) and buy-small (h6) emerged as the most stress-resilient pair

#	Hypothesis	Status	Key assumptions
1	Buy 10 Cr Bangalore — roots, stability, forced savings	Catastrophic if wrong	Premium appreciation 6-8% [G1] · No life event forces relocation · Forced savings beats portfolio leak
2a	Rent + invest, disciplined (full delta, 10 years)	Theoretically optimal	100% delta invested 10 yrs · 12% CAGR sustained · Behavioural drag avoided
2b	Rent + invest, realistic (65% invested, behavioural drag)	Most likely 2a outcome	Discipline drifts · Family obligations drain corpus · Lifestyle inflation
3	Relocate to SF — USD earnings, corrected savings	Career-justified, not wealth	H1B 55% by yr 3 [G5] · Savings $80-120K [G4] · Career trajectory worth family cost
4	Hybrid remote — SF salary from Bangalore	Weakened	Already breaking · RTO mandates · Geo-pay compression · Transfer pricing
5	Staged real-options — rent now, SF conditional on visa	Recommended Phase 1	Phase 1 standalone valuable · Sequential P=0.16 joint · Real-options framing
6	Buy small (4-5 Cr) + invest rest — roots without the cage	Recommended endpoint	EMI 45K/mo single-income sustainable · Highest stress-resilience · Family Advocate proposal

Source: Decision Brief — Hypotheses Explored

On reversibility × commitment risk, h5 and h6 cluster manageable; h1 amplifies under any life event



READ

- h1 — Buy 10 Cr — golden cage if life event forces exit (12-18 mo sale, 15-20% haircut)
- h3 — Relocate SF — visa fragility + double-wipeout exposure (P=0.08 catastrophic)
- h4 — Hybrid remote — already weakening (P=0.08), RTO + geo-pay compression
- h2a — Rent disciplined — theoretical optimum, depends on 70% investment rate × 11% CAGR
- h2b — Rent realistic — 65% invested with behavioural drag (slow leak risk)
- h6 — Buy small — highest stress-resilience score, 45K EMI single-income sustainable
- h5 — Staged real-options — Phase 1 standalone valuable, real-options chain to h3 or h6

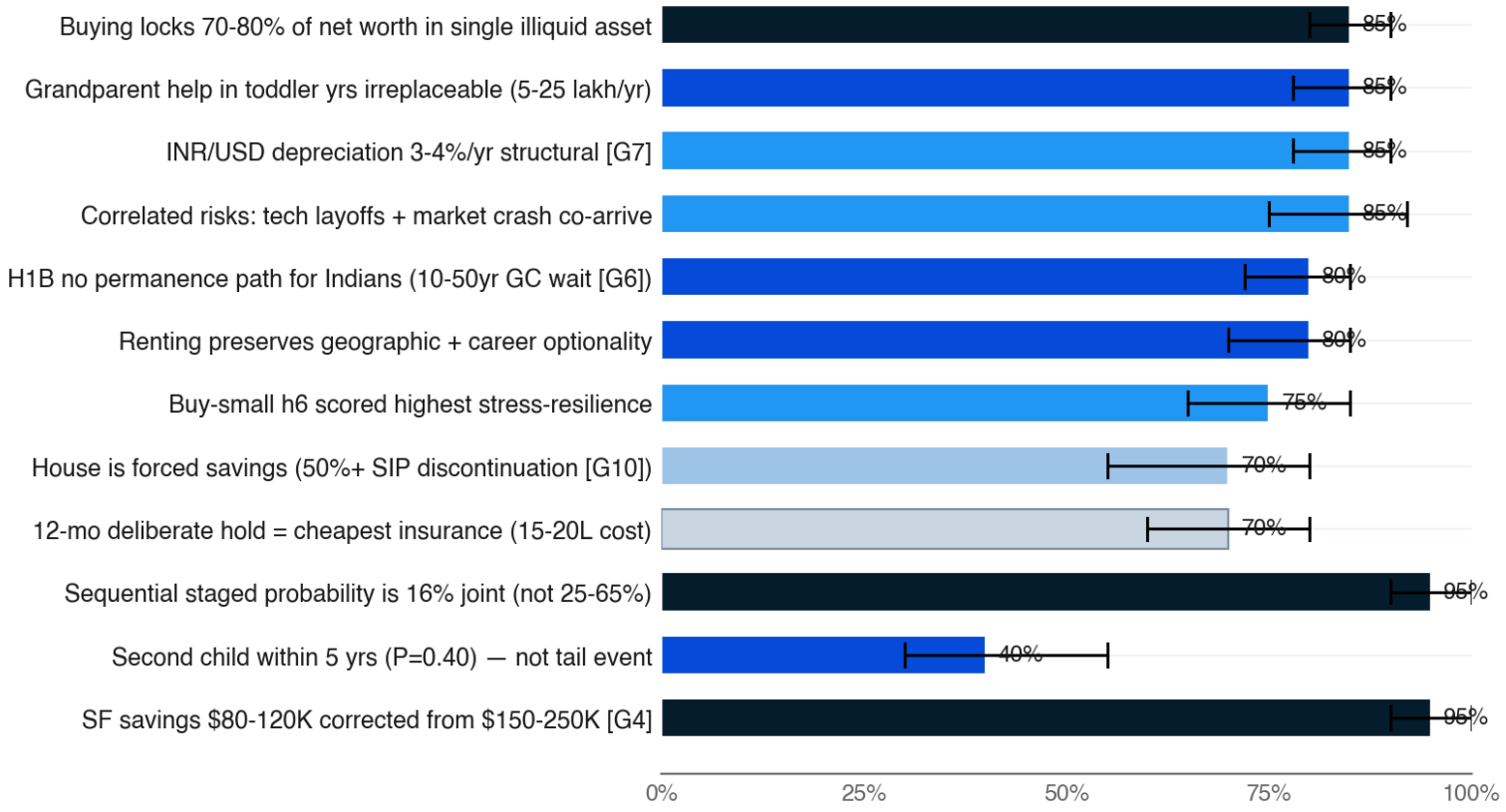
Source: Synthesis from Decision Brief — bubble size = council_agreement × probability of dominance

PART 3

What the council found

Where the personas converged, where they diverged, and what the disagreement itself reveals about the decision.

The strongest signals: liquidity lock-in under buying, behavioural leakage under disciplined renting



- Top 12 effects ranked by council_agreement × probability
- Bar color = council agreement (navy = 5/5, fading to pale = 1/5)
- Black bracket = persona disagreement range — width is the uncertainty signal
- Iteration 2 corrected SF savings 50% downward — biggest assumption shift in the analysis
- Sequential probability finding (P=0.95 confidence) reframed h5 from 25-65% to 16% joint, forcing a real-options framing

Source: Decision Brief — High-Confidence Effects + Critical Findings · [G4], [G5], [G10]

The deepest disagreement — discipline vs forced savings — IS the data; values-driven, not information-limited

STRONGEST: CONSTRAINT ANALYST (9.1/10)

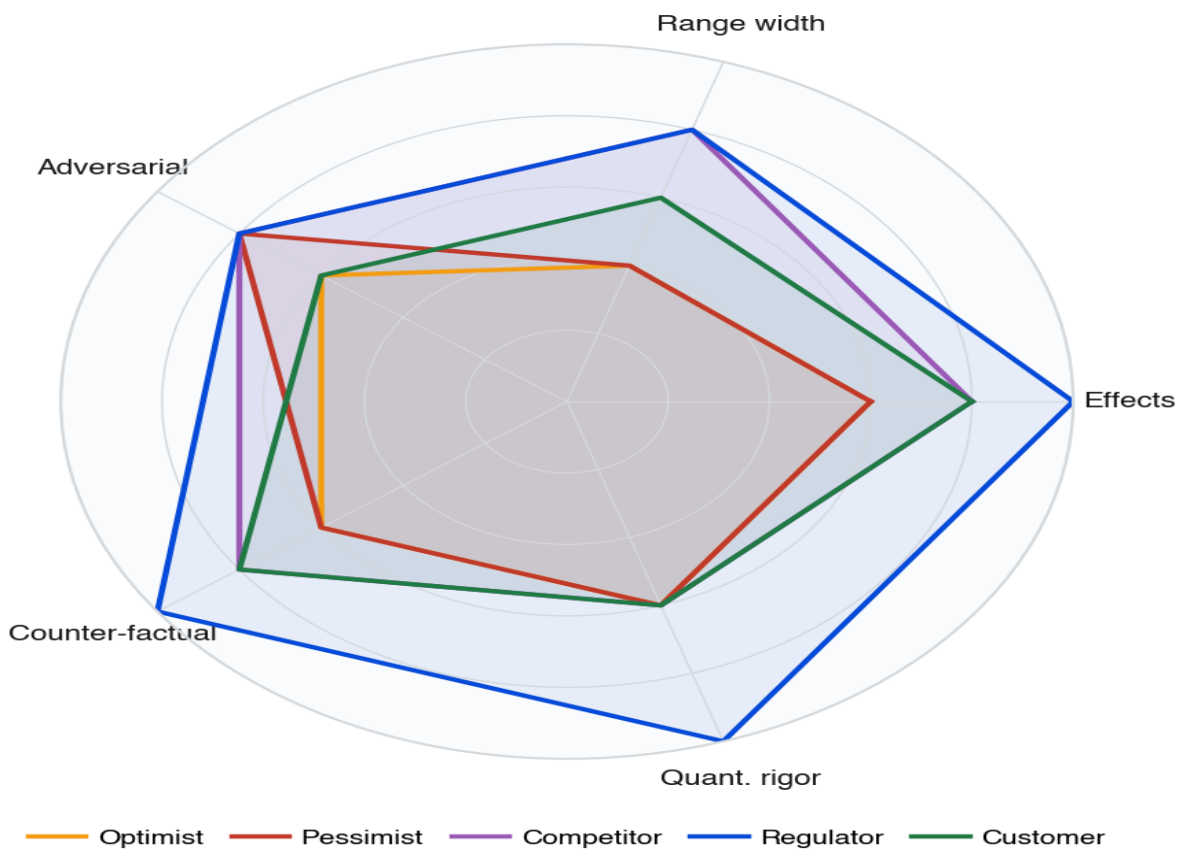
- Highest peer score on tax + structural depth — DTAA planning, RNOR window, Section 24 cap, removed indexation
- Surfaced the single highest-ROI recommendation: hire a cross-border tax advisor (cost 1-2 lakh, saves 10-15 lakh if SF executes)
- Identified INR depreciation 3-4%/yr [G7] as structural constant — strongest empirical assumption in the analysis (10-yr USD savings ~35-45% more powerful when converted)
- Most calibrated quantitative rigor — every assumption tied to a specific source row in Data Foundation

DEEPEST DIVIDE: DISCIPLINE VS FORCED SAVINGS

- Optimist + Family Advocate: rent+invest theoretically beats buying at 70% investment rate × 11% CAGR
- Adversary + Constraint Analyst: 50%+ of Indian families discontinue SIPs within 3 years [G10] — the house IS the savings mechanism
- Council converges on EFFECTS (buying locks liquidity, visa fragile, grandparent help matters) but diverges on CONCLUSIONS because they weight effects differently
- This is the hallmark of a values-driven decision — more analysis will not resolve the disagreement; only the couple's own values can
- BLIND SPOT caught: marriage strain initially modeled by 1/5 personas (Family Advocate) — added across all hypotheses in iteration 2

Source: Decision Brief — Council Dynamics + Convergence Log

Constraint Analyst scored highest on tax depth; Pessimist's narrow ranges drove its lowest peer rank



- Each persona scored 1-5 across five rigor dimensions, derived from Council Dynamics narrative
- Constraint Analyst (Regulator slot, dark blue) — visibly largest area, mirroring its #1 peer rank (9.1/10)
- Family Advocate (Customer slot) caught the marriage-strain blind spot AND proposed the buy-small alternative that became the recommended endpoint
- Pessimist's systematically low probabilities (0.10-0.35 across all options) reduced discriminatory power — narrow ranges + low confidence = small radar area
- Optimist's 0.10 weight on buying created extreme skew — flagged in iter-2 as not matching the decision-maker's values

Source: Synthesized from Decision Brief — Council Dynamics narrative

Three worst-cases plus two structural findings — h5/h6's staged structure neutralizes 4 of 5

WORST CASES

- Double Wipeout (P=0.08): US recession dual-layoff + Nifty crashes 35-40%; 5-7 yr recovery; exposes h2/h3/h5 simultaneously
- Golden Cage (P=0.12): bought 10 Cr; 18 mo later child needs medical care abroad / AQI triggers asthma; house = anchor not home
- Slow Leak (P=0.18): rent+invest, year 5 corpus halved by family obligations + lifestyle inflation; year 7 less than starting point

STRUCTURAL FINDINGS

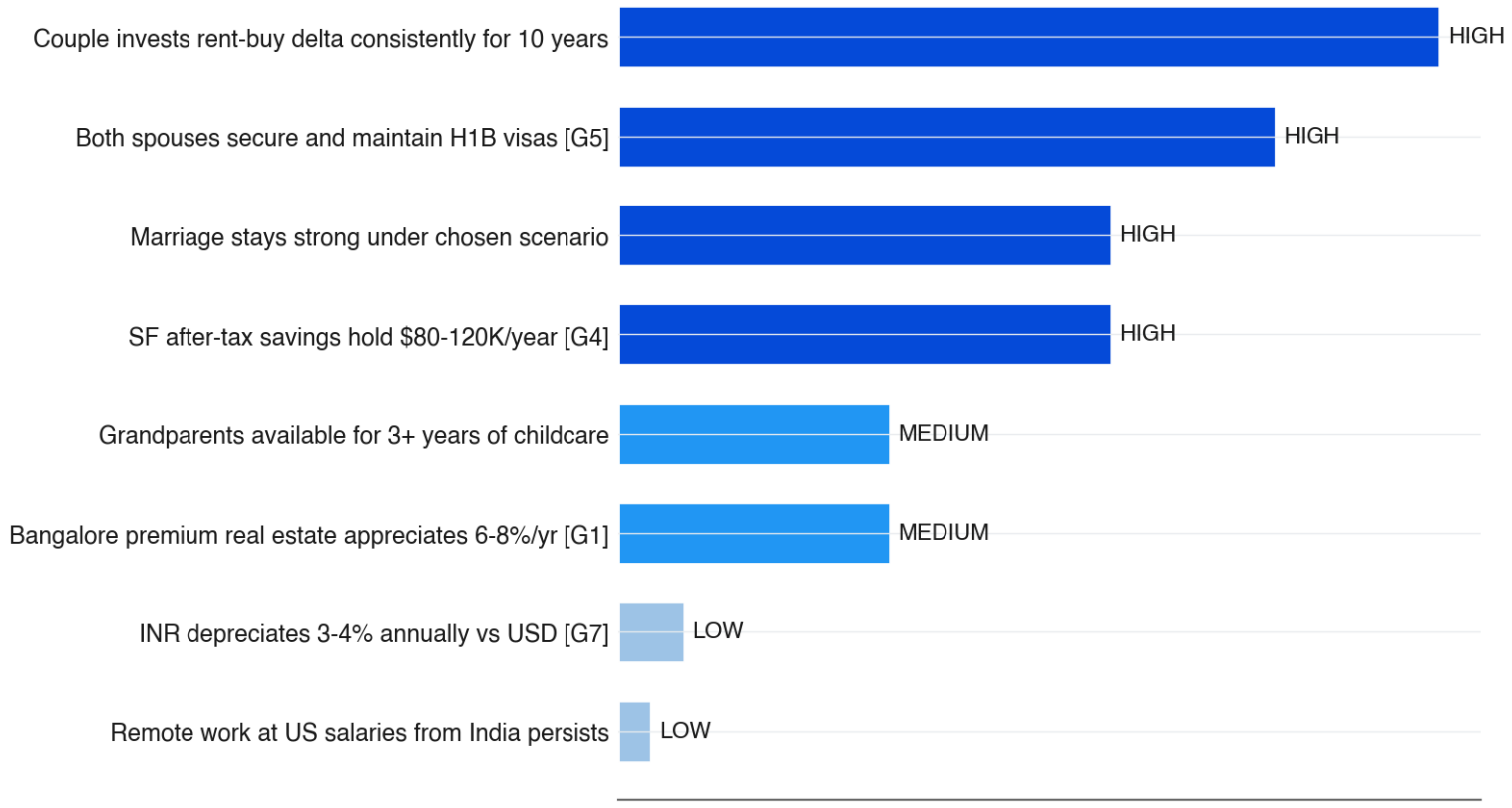
- Sequential Probability — staged path 16% joint (Phase1 70% × Phase2 50% × Phase3 45%), not the 25-65% the council assigned by evaluating phases independently
- Correlated Risks — tech layoffs and equity crashes are NOT independent. The scenario where you lose H1B sponsor IS the scenario where Indian portfolio is also down 30%
- Marriage strain initially modeled by 1/5 personas — added across all hypotheses in iter-2

MITIGATIONS

- Phase 1 (rent + grandparents + 70/30 SIP) is dominant standalone — defuses Double Wipeout and Slow Leak entry points
- Buy-small endpoint (h6) defuses Golden Cage — 4-5 Cr is exitable; 45K EMI is single-income sustainable
- Real-options reframe of h5: Phase 1 is the bet; Phase 2/3 are options exercised conditional on visa + alignment + discipline data
- Quarterly kill criteria (SIP <60%, happiness <5/10) convert behavioural assumptions into observable triggers

Source: Decision Brief — Adversarial Scenarios + Critical Findings

Four high-sensitivity assumptions are load-bearing — discipline, visa, savings, and marriage all shakeable



- Bar length = sensitivity weight × number of effects impacted
- Dark-blue bar = HIGH sensitivity, lighter = MEDIUM, palest = LOW
- Three of four HIGH-sensitivity assumptions are FRAGILE per adversary — investment discipline, H1B, marriage alignment all break under realistic stress
- INR depreciation [G7] is the SOLID load-bearer — empirical 30-yr trend, RBI-supported, single most powerful argument for some USD-earning years
- Behavioural assumption (#1) is testable in first 12 months — if SIP rate <70%, the answer is already known: buy small

Source: Decision Brief — Key Assumptions Ranked by Sensitivity · [G1], [G4], [G5], [G7]

PART 4

Path forward

Sixteen checkpoints from Month 0 to Year 10 — Gate 1 at Year 3 is where the staged path commits or pivots.

The recommendation maps to a staged checkpoint timeline with kill criteria gating the year-3 decision

Phase 1 (M0-36) is dominant standalone. Gate 1 splits to SF (h3+staged) or buy-small (h6).

When	Action	Decision point	Kill criteria
Month 0	Cross-border tax advisor + locked SIP (joint approval >5L)	Both spouses agree on lock mechanism	One spouse resists lock → alignment gap surfaced
Month 1	Rent near grandparents + H1B/L1/EB1A eligibility scan	Lease secured; sponsorship paths known	No employer sponsors → SF needs job change first
Month 3	First SIP discipline check (>=70% of planned delta)	Actual investment vs plan	<70% in 1st quarter → discuss openly
Month 6	First couple alignment check (both >=7/10 happiness)	Honest formal conversation	Either <5/10 → fundamental issue
Month 12	Annual review: SIP + visa + alignment + child dev	All four data points	SIP <60% for 2 quarters → start 4-5 Cr search
Year 1-2	H1B lottery (April each year) + L1/EB1A pursuit	USCIS results	Both fail 2 yrs → deprioritize SF
Year 2	Evaluate second-child timeline	Couple family planning	2nd child likely → extend Phase 1 by 1-2 yrs
Year 3	GATE 1 — visa AND enthusiasm AND discipline?	Decision tree from recommendation	Any one missing → execute Buy-Small (h6)
Y3 Buy	Purchase 4-5 Cr apartment; continue SIP on remainder	Property + loan	Preferred area too expensive → adjacent
Y3 SF	Begin SF job search timed to kindergarten window	Visa-sponsored offers ready	Offers weak → delay 6-12 mo, do not force
Y4-5 SF	Child enters US kindergarten (developmental window)	School enrollment + housing	Enrollment fails → backup intl school in BLR
Year 5	SF mid-term review: career trajectory worth family cost?	Savings + career growth + family health	Savings <$80K/yr or strain high → plan return
Y8-10	Evaluate return with USD savings + RNOR window	Child preferences + career + corpus	Child resists return → phase may not execute
Ongoing	Quarterly monitoring triggers (SIP, AQI, AI compression)	Automated reports + couple check-ins	Each trigger has its own action

Source: Decision Brief — Appendix A: Decision Timeline

Selected sources

Tags appear inline throughout the deck — [G#] = ground data (synthesized from Data Foundation table; this brief predates schema v1.1)

Tag	Type	Claim	Source
G1	Ground	Bangalore premium appreciation 6-8% headline / 2-3% real after tax	NoBroker, 99acres (2024-2026)
G2	Ground	Nifty 50 10-year CAGR 7-17% by entry; 12-14% consensus	BSE historical data
G3	Ground	SF dual-tech household income $350-500K gross	Levels.fyi, Glassdoor
G4	Ground	SF realistic annual savings $80-120K (corrected from $150-250K)	CA tax 48-50% + housing + childcare model
G5	Ground	H1B household visa probability 20% yr1 / 55% yr3 / 72% yr5	USCIS lottery cumulative
G6	Ground	India EB2/EB3 green card wait 10-50+ years	USCIS Visa Bulletin
G7	Ground	INR/USD depreciation 3-4% annually (30-year trend)	RBI historical data
G8	Ground	Premium Bangalore rental yield 3-4.5%	Business Standard (2024)
G9	Ground	EMI on 7-8 Cr loan at 8.5% = 85-90K/month	Standard amortization
G10	Ground	Indian SIP discontinuation rate 50%+ within 3 years	AMFI, Morningstar India

Source: Decision Brief — Data Foundation table (synthesized into [G#] tags; brief predates ## Sources schema)